

A focused guide to spotting AI-generated video and voice, and the scams that ride them.

\$25.6M

stolen in a single deepfake video call (Arup)

CNN / FT, 2024

0.1%

of people correctly spotted every deepfake in a test

iProov, 2025

\$40B

projected US AI-enabled fraud by 2027, from \$12.3B in 2023

Deloitte, 2024

SIGNS THE VIDEO OR VOICE IS SYNTHETIC

- 01

Audio and video that drift

Lip-sync that lags, odd blinking, flat lighting, or a voice that sounds slightly off.
- 02

Camera or mic problems on cue

They will not turn on a clear camera, or quality drops the moment you ask a hard question.

REQUESTS THAT SHOULD MAKE YOU STOP

- 03

Urgency on a live call

A senior leader on video pressing for an immediate, secret transfer or login.
- 04

A request that skips process

Approve now, the usual approver is away, keep this between us.
- 05

New payment details by voice or video

Bank or wallet changes pushed in a call, never entered in the system of record.
- 06

Pressure not to verify

Discouraging a callback, a second approver, or an in-person check.
- 07

Context that does not fit

An executive contacting you directly for something they would normally delegate.

WHERE DEEPPAKES SHOW UP

- 08

Live video calls with 'leadership'

An urgent meeting where a senior face asks you to pay or hand over access.
- 09

Voice notes and phone calls

A cloned voice of a relative or a boss, usually inside a manufactured crisis.
- 10

Investment and celebrity ads

A known figure 'endorsing' a platform or a giveaway in a polished clip.

DO / DON'T

- DO

- Treat any urgent money or access request as unverified until you confirm it live.
 - Call the real person back on a number you already have.
 - Ask a question only the real person could answer.
 - Confirm payments in your finance system of record, not over a call.
 - Agree on a private code word with family and your finance team.
- DON'T

- Do not trust a face or a voice alone. Both can be faked from seconds of public media.
 - Do not act on a transfer or login request made only over video or audio.
 - Do not let 'keep this secret' or 'the approver is away' bypass your process.
 - Do not assume a live camera proves the person is real.

THE ONE MOVE

The one move that beats a deepfake: hang up and verify on a channel you chose. Call the person back on a known number, confirm in your finance system, or check in person. A real executive will not punish a callback. An attacker cannot survive one.

IF IT HAPPENS

- 1

Pause the request and end the call if you can.
- 2

Verify with the real person on a channel you chose.
- 3

If money already moved, call your bank to recall the wire immediately.
- 4

Report it to ic3.gov and tell your security or finance team.

Sources: Hong Kong police / Arup (reported by CNN, FT), 2024; iProov, 2025; Deloitte Center for Financial Services, 2024. Figures as publicly reported.

How this is made: threat level: human is an AI-assisted production. A real person researches every story, checks each claim against primary sources, and is accountable for the facts.